

operations that favors general purpose chips like the CPUs found in PCs.⁴⁸ Beyond a focus on more egalitarian proof-of-work, CryptoNote provided untraceable payments, unlinkable transactions, and blockchain analysis resistance.⁴⁹ Adam Back is considered the inspiration for Satoshi's proof-of-work algorithm and is president of Blockstream, one of the most important companies in the Bitcoin space. In March 2014, he tweeted about CryptoNote, saying it was one of the few ideas in the cryptocurrency space outside of Bitcoin that held a "defensible rationale for existence."⁵⁰

Some may ask why Monero stole the show from Bytecoin. Bytecoin's blockchain and the issuance of its currency, bytecoin, started on July 4, 2012, but it did not become widely known until almost two years later when an announcement for it appeared on bitcointalk.org on March 12, 2014.⁵¹ People were intrigued but confused about why the Bytecoin team had taken two years to make it public. Some argued that it was because the developers wanted to make sure the technology was soundly running before drawing more attention. Others argued that something more insidious was at play, called a *premine* (pronounced "pre-mine").

Bytecoin planned to issue 184.46 billion bytecoin via the mining process, but by the time it was made publicly known, 150 billion bytecoin were already in existence, more than 80 percent of the total supply.⁵² A classic premine, Bytecoin had quietly released a large amount of the coins in a manner that disadvantaged the broader community. Bitcoin and the permissionless blockchain movement was founded on